Blending I Spy

Why we love it

This exercise is all about hearing the sounds of language. Blending together the sounds of a word is a helpful first step towards learning to decode written words.

Materials

Sound Cards (Optional)

Instructions

- This activity uses the format of the classic game “I Spy,” but instead of using colors, you will use the individual sounds of a word.
- First, choose an object in your environment that is visible to the child or use the cards (i.e. a clock).
- Then say, “I spy with my little eye...” and say the individual sounds in the word with a bit of silence in between (i.e. /k/.../l/.../o/.../k/). *tip: gaps between sounds should last around a half of a second.
- The child’s job is to blend the sounds together to make the whole word, and then spot the object (i.e. child says “Clock!” and points to the clock.

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Blending Fly Swat

Why we love it

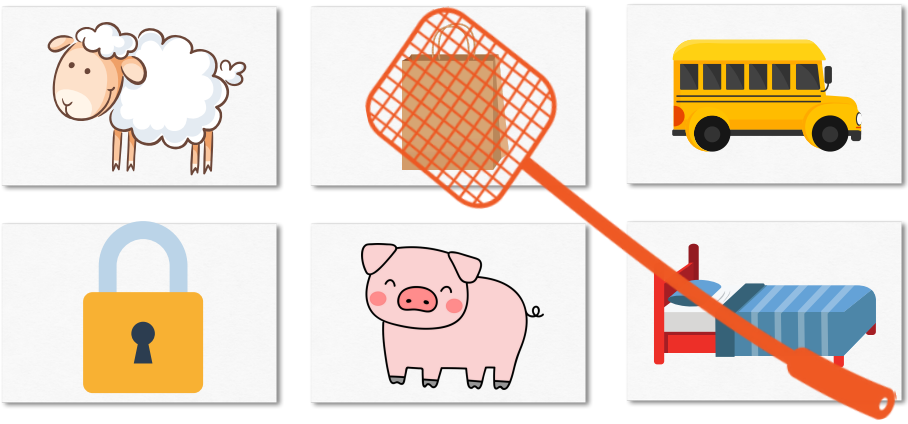
This exercise is all about building up the speedy sound-blending skills that help early readers decode whole words. Many children love this game's emphasis on speed.

Materials

Sound Cards

Instructions

- Lay sound cards on the table and tape them down.
- Start with a small amount of cards that only have two or three sounds. You may start with 3-4 sound cards; you can add more cards with more sounds as your child becomes more comfortable.
- Explain to your child: "In this game, we are pretending that there is a fly flying around our house. I am going to tell you where it lands, but I can only say it in this funny way, one sound at time. Then you say the whole word while you swat the fly as quickly as you can!"
- For example, you could say the fly landed on the "/b/ /a/ /g/". Your child would blend the sounds to say "bag" and swat the card that says "bag"!
- Your child can use a fly swatter, or a spatula or just their hand!
- As their speed improves, add more pictures!



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